the only ones that influence India's and China's perceptions. Yet, my sense is that the three we deal with capture quite a lot of Indian and Chinese ways of seeing.

Indian Worldviews and China

India has three big worldviews – a classical, a modern cosmopolitan, and a Great Power view. The classical view goes back to its Hindu past, to the era of Kautilya's *Arthashastra* and Kamandaki's *Nitisara*, which were most likely composed somewhere between the third century BCE and the second century CE. Beginning in the early twenty-first century, the *Arthashastra* in particular has drawn increasing interest in India (and elsewhere), with several interpretations of it. The modern cosmopolitan view can be traced to Indian thinkers from about Vivekananda onward to at least Rabindranath Tagore and Mahatma Gandhi. The Great Power view is evident in the thinking of a range of social thinkers including Nehru and M.S. Golwalkar and contemporary strategists such as Bharat Karnad.

Kautilya

The Kautilyan view is of states (or state-like entities) operating in a world of other states, constantly eyeing each other preparing for war. It is a world of contention and conflict, with a potential *vijigisu* ('conqueror') aspiring to expand the realm. In this world, the big fish eat the small fish, the strong conquer the weak. When the vijigisu expands to the limits of the known world, he or she becomes the *chakravartin* or universal ruler – in a modern setting, this probably means regional hegemony rather than global dominance. In the *mandala* world of Kautilya, other states are enemies, allies, neutrals, and mediators, with neighbours usually rating as enemies. Expansion may be brought about by various means: '*sama* (conciliation or alliance), *dana* (placating and winning over with gifts), *danda* (punishing through the use of force), and *bheda* (sowing dissension)'. Danda is only to